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User roles for Cold Wallet workspaces

Note

Creating a Fireblocks Cold Wallet workspace requires scheduling onboarding time. For more information please contact your [Customer Success Manager](#).

Overview

Cold Wallet workspaces have different user roles and privileges than hot wallet workspaces. This article highlights the main differences. Significantly, only Signers can sign transactions, which means there is no Admin role as in a hot wallet workspace. A workspace Policy is still used to designate users for authorizing and signing transactions.

For information about the user roles in an online signing workspace, see [User roles](#).

Cold wallet user role access table

Role	Owner	Non-Signing Admin	Signer	Approver	Editor	Viewer
Software	Fireblocks Cold Wallet mobile app	Fireblocks mobile app or API User	Fireblocks Cold Wallet mobile app	Fireblocks mobile app	No need for mobile app (Console or API user)	No need for mobile app (Console or API user)

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Sign transactions	No	No	Yes	No	No	No
Create vault accounts	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Submit connections for approval	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Approve connection	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
View all workspace settings	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No
Approve MPC signing devices	Yes	No	No	No	No	No
Export transaction history	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Submit whitelisting requests	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Approve whitelisting requests	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No

Legend

✓	Full Access - same as online signing workspaces.
Yes*	Full Access - Only if the Policy defines a designated signer. (A user with signing privileges assigned to sign transactions submitted by other users.) This is unlike online signing workspaces.
**	Approving transactions requires identifying specific users in the Policy

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Owner

The Owner's device must be an offline device running the Fireblocks Cold Wallet mobile app. Their device holds the root MPC key share that all signing device keys are derived from, but **they can not sign transactions**.

The Owner's Cold Wallet device is required for approving and generating MPC key shares for Cold Wallet signing devices.

By default, the owner cannot initiate transactions because they cannot sign those transactions. However, it is possible to configure Policy rules to designate a Signer for transactions initiated by the owner.

Admin

The Admin user role is **not available** in Cold Wallet workspaces.

Non-Signing-Admin users can approve transactions according to your Policies and participate in the Admin Quorum. Non-Signing Admins do not hold MPC key shares and use the Fireblocks mobile app with an online device.

Signer

Signers in a Cold Wallet workspace are the only user role that can sign transactions. Their MPC key shares are stored on an air-gapped, offline iOS device using the Fireblocks Cold Wallet app. Each Signer in the Cold Wallet workspace requires their own iOS device that is locked in a supervised mode during the [setup process](#) and is used for the offline signature processes.

Signers may also take part in transaction approval if required by the Policy. Transactions are approved using their Cold Wallet device by scanning a QR animation in the Fireblocks Console Cold Wallet signing panel. [Learn more about the Cold Wallet transaction signing process.](#)

Security Manager

The **Security Manager** is not a specific workspace user, but a person authorized to provision every Cold Wallet iOS device and verify that it is locked in supervised mode and can only open Fireblocks Cold Wallet at the end of the setup process. This person does not require an account login to your Fireblocks workspace.

The Security Manager requires a MacOS computer running Apple Configurator in order to provision new Cold Wallet signing devices.

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Managing Cold Wallet users

Adding, removing, and modifying users, and API Keys currently requires contacting [Fireblocks Support](#). If the Owner did not submit the support ticket, then Fireblocks Support requests written approval for confirming any workspace changes.

Best practices

In order to protect the safety and security of the Owner's device that holds the root MPC key used to generate all signing keys, Fireblocks recommends separating the **Owner user role** from daily blockchain operations and trading. The Owner should limit their activity to only approving new signing devices if possible. The Owner's offline device should be stored securely at all times.

For ease of operation, Fireblocks recommends creating one or more users with a **Non-Signing Admin** role to approve workspace modifications instead of using the owner's Cold Wallet device. Non-signing Admins use the Fireblocks mobile app with an online device to easily approve transactions, new external connections, new whitelisted addresses, workspace settings changes, and more.

Actions that can ideally be assigned to Non-Signing Admins include:

- Approving transactions
- Approving new exchange connections
- Whitelisting new addresses
- Viewing and modifying workspace settings
- Approving changes to workspace settings

Actions that require the Owner's Cold Wallet device:

- Approving MPC signing devices

Fireblocks recommends separating transaction creation, approval, and signing steps using your Policy. Only Signers should be responsible for creating new transactions and signing them because these steps require an MPC key using the Fireblocks Cold Wallet app. Transactions should be approved by **Non-Signing-Admins** and **Approvers** because they only require the Fireblocks online app, which immediately receives notifications when approval is required.

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